

Parks Board Meeting September 15, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7IGHqHoUaVo
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Parks Board was called to order by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Brad (Presiding Officer), Carl (Parks Superintendent), Taylor Beard (Prairie Creek representative), Ashley, and other board members.
 - *Members Absent:* Not explicitly noted in the transcript.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Brad.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not explicitly addressed in this transcript portion.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:06:28 Parks Department Monthly Report & Event Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl, Parks Superintendent.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Carl provided updates on storm recovery and park conditions across Muncie. Westside Park is currently closed due to severe storm damage and upcoming public works renovation plans; however, Muncie Clean and Beautiful insisted on holding their annual river cleanup event there. The board clarified that while full-scale restoration is paused, open facilities remain accessible. Other discussed items included unauthorized parking and grass destruction along Ninth Street (requiring coordination with code enforcement), tree removal at McCulloch Park, playground mulch and surfacing repairs, splash pad winterization schedules, and upcoming events including a Ball State men's basketball community game at Ein Park and the annual Trunk or Treat at Heekin Park on October 24th (partnered with Walmart, Boys and Girls Club, and YWCA).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal vote taken.
- **00:24:00 Halterman Park Car Show Proposal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl, Parks Superintendent (presenting a request from a community member).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A request was submitted to host a car show at Halterman Park featuring 15 to 20 cars (potentially up to 25) and four vendors on October 17th. Board members discussed parking constraints, green space utilization, and the need to set clear limits to prevent overcrowding.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (capped at 25 vehicles, with discretion given to staff on exact placement or venue adjustments).
- **00:30:38 Community Basketball & Kickball Event Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representative from the annual event organization (fourth annual event).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented an application for the fourth annual elementary and middle school basketball/kickball event paired with local first responders (police, sheriff, EMTs, firefighters), scheduled for October 27th. The Bridge Community Church will assist with pumpkin painting, and meals/snacks will be provided at no cost. Presenter apologized for the late submission due to contact changes.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** The event organizer spoke regarding the coordination needs and community benefits.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:32:55 Riverside Normal City Neighborhood Association Historical Signs Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Beth Mesner, Riverside Normal City Neighborhood Association.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Beth Mesner provided an update regarding historical markers for the Tuley sign and Emerson dog park sign. Content has been reviewed and approved for historical accuracy by the Delaware County Historical Society and

Minnetrissa. Legal review is pending. The association is utilizing remaining ARP funding (which must be encumbered/spent by December) and requested guidance on park locations, sign fabrication timelines, and whether the parks department can assist with storage and installation.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Beth Mesner presented the update and answered board questions.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus given to proceed subject to final legal review and coordination with the parks department on installation and location. No formal vote required.
- **00:37:59 "Friday Night Lights" High School Baseball Series Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Randy O'Connor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Randy O'Connor presented a concept for a "Friday Night Lights" high school baseball series at Gamebridge Field (McCulloch Park), aiming to bring county high schools in to play under the lights against outside opponents, paired with youth development camps ("Future Stars"). Six high schools have committed, with outreach ongoing. Discussion covered flood damage repairs to the turf (\$3,000 baseline repair), safety netting/partitions for bleachers, parking logistics, security, and potential partnership with the Muncie Sports Commission / Community Sports Development Initiative (CSDI) for funding and grant structuring.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Randy O'Connor presented the proposal and answered board inquiries.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; encouraged to coordinate further with the parks superintendent and Muncie Sports Commission. No final action vote taken.
- **01:01:13 Prairie Creek Reservoir Operations & Repair Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Taylor Beard, Prairie Creek Reservoir.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Taylor Beard reported on ongoing flood recovery efforts, specifically dock and pier repairs. Out of 175 wooden piers, significant work remains, including 11 requiring complete rebuilding and others needing replacement boards and poles. Six staff members were publicly recognized for their hard work. The beach is officially closed for the season, though the boat launch remains open through October 31st. Upcoming events include the Reservoir Ramble Adventure Race (Sept 20), Rubble Racing Triathlon (Sept 27), and a catfish tournament.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no vote taken.
- **01:06:52 The Crossing High School Beach Shelter Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Taylor Beard, Prairie Creek Reservoir.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Crossing High School requested free admission to beach shelters 1 and 2 on September 25th for a school field trip involving 10 to 25 students. Because weekday shelter bookings are rare, this would result in no lost revenue.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:01:12 Old Business: Flatland Resources Project Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** David Helman, Flatland Resources.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** David Helman provided updates on active design-build projects:
 1. *Tilson Pond Park:* Experienced 8 to 9 feet of standing water due to Buck Creek overtopping its banks during a major flood event. Pumping operations are underway through filter bags. The project timeline has been extended by the city through the end of September next year, though summer completion is anticipated.
 2. *Prairie Creek Trails:* Coordination ongoing with Indiana American Water to locate an underwater culvert crossing at Huffman Ditch before submitting permits to the Army Corps of Engineers and IDEM.
 3. *Anna Park:* Funded by State Representatives' office money; includes play structures, swings, and a newly added shade structure/benches/grills. Projected completion is late October.
 4. *Memorial Avenue Canoe Launch:* Stone base installed; paving scheduled by year's end, funded by a Ball Brothers Foundation grant.
 5. *White River Educational Signs:* Delaware County Soil and Water Conservation District received a grant for educational signs at canoe launches and is developing an MOU for board/legal review.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **01:19:28 Old Business: Five-Year Parks Master Plan Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ashley (Board Member / Committee participant).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Two committee meetings have been held to work on drafting the updated five-year parks master plan. Focus groups and public outreach strategies (including QR codes at parks) are being organized. A draft is due to the DNR in November, with final submission expected in April.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report.
- **01:22:05 Old Business: Back to Back Monthly Homecoming**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Presiding Officer) & Carl.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board briefly revisited a tabled event proposal for a homecoming event (noted for August 2027). Representatives were not present, and the board noted the need to follow up to ensure dates and security logistics are clarified well in advance.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled / Held for future follow-up.
- **01:33:39 Budget Discussions**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl & Brad.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed the city council's recently introduced budget. Carl noted his upcoming department head session with the mayor on September 28th, while Taylor Beard noted his session on the 30th. Brad noted concerns regarding capital equipment omissions in the initial proposal and offered board support.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No formal open public forum timestamped as a distinct citizen comment period occurred near the end of the meeting; however, organizational representatives spoke during specific agenda items as noted above.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Carl noted an upcoming meeting with a representative from the Storey Neighborhood Association regarding potential ARP fund allocations for park improvements.
 - The next regular meeting is scheduled for **Tuesday, October 20th** (noting Presiding Officer Brad will be absent due to a family conflict).
 - **Adjournment:** Approved by Voice Vote to adjourn.
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